



香港中文大學(深圳)
The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen

Operating Systems

Lecture 4

System programming: processes and files

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Acknowledgments: Ion Stoica and Matei Zaharia, Berkeley CS 162

Recall: OS library API for threads: *pthread*

Output

```
int pthread_create(pthread_t *thread, const pthread_attr_t *attr,  
                  void *(*start_routine)(void*), void *arg);
```

- thread is created executing start_routine with arg as its sole argument.
- return is implicit call to pthread_exit
- (attr contains info like stack size, scheduling policy, etc)

Input

```
void pthread_exit(void *value_ptr);
```

- terminates the thread and makes value_ptr available to any successful join

Input

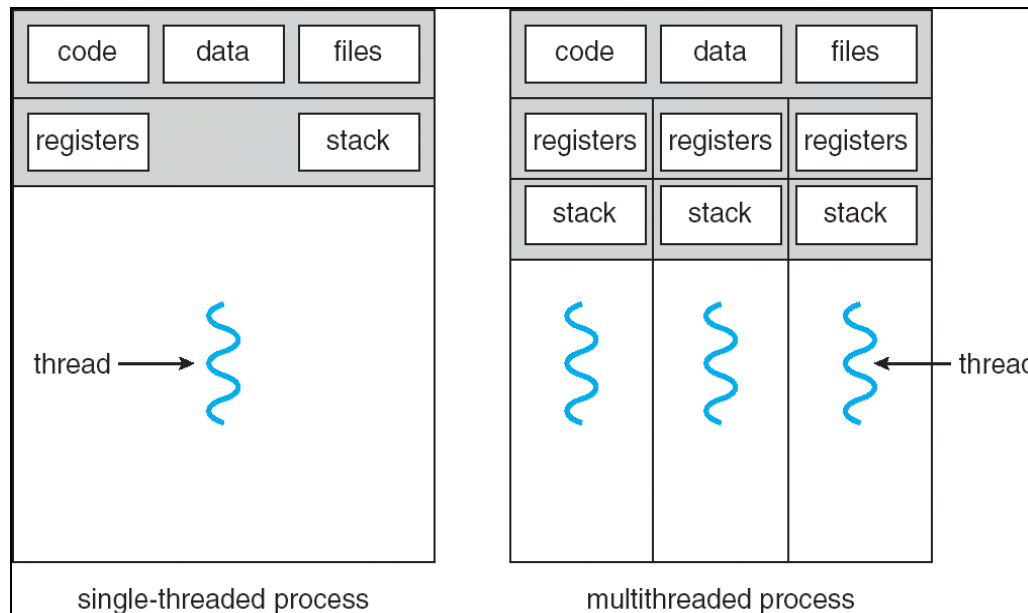
```
int pthread_join(pthread_t thread, void **value_ptr);
```

Output

- suspends execution of the calling thread until the target thread terminates.
- On return with a non-NULL value_ptr the value passed to pthread_exit() by the terminating thread is made available in the location referenced by value_ptr.

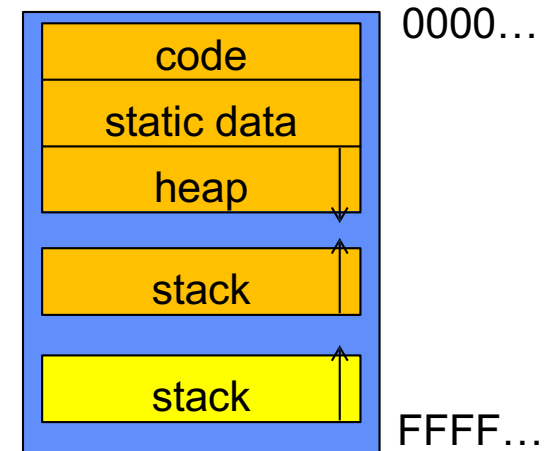
Recall: process

- Processes consists of
 - One or more threads
 - Address space, and other resources shared by the threads within the same process



Recall: memory layout with two threads

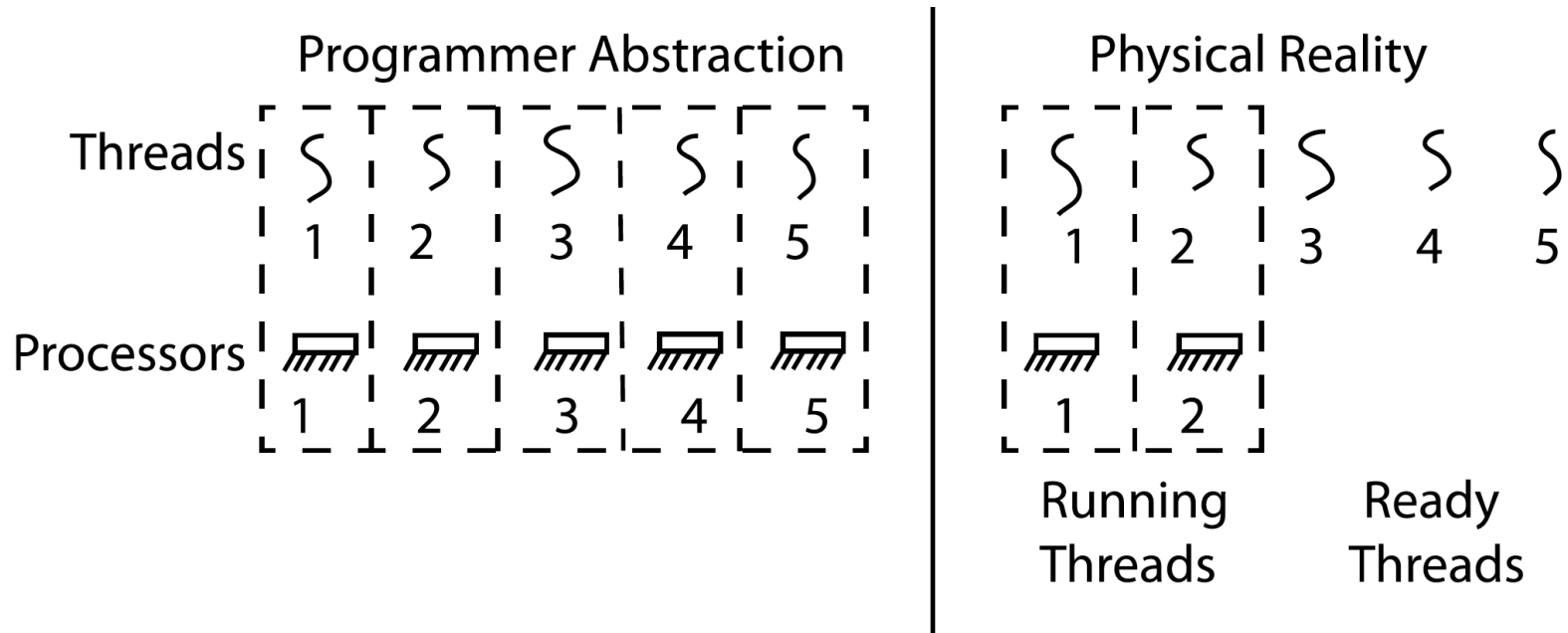
- Two sets of CPU registers
- Two sets of Stacks
- Issues:
 - How do we position stacks relative to each other?
 - What maximum size should we choose for the stacks?
 - What happens if threads violate this?
 - How might you catch violations?



INTERLEAVING and NONDETERMINISM

(the beginning of a long discussion)

Thread abstraction



- Illusion: Infinite number of processors
- Reality: threads execute with variable “speed”
 - Programs must be designed to work with any schedule

Programmer's vs. processor's view

Programmer's
View

.
.
.
x = x + 1;
y = y + x;
z = x + 5y;
.
.
.

Possible
Execution
#1

.
.
.
x = x + 1;
y = y + x;
z = x + 5y;
.
.
.

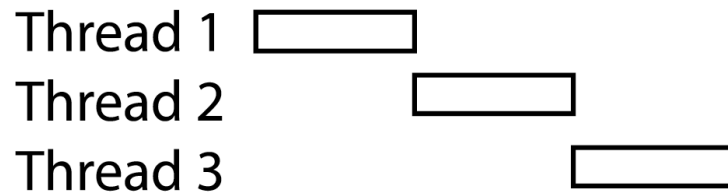
Possible
Execution
#2

.
.
.
x = x + 1
.....
thread is suspended
other thread(s) run
thread is resumed
.....
y = y + x
z = x + 5y

Possible
Execution
#3

.
.
.
x = x + 1
y = y + x
.....
thread is suspended
other thread(s) run
thread is resumed
.....
z = x + 5y

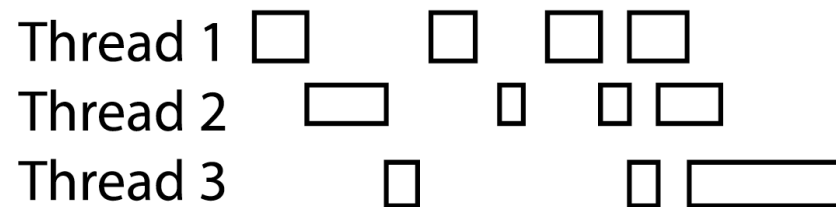
Possible executions



a) One execution



b) Another execution



c) Another execution

Correctness vs. concurrent threads

- Non-determinism:
 - Scheduler can run threads in any order
 - Scheduler can switch threads at any time
 - This can make testing very difficult
- Independent threads
 - No state shared with other threads
 - Deterministic, reproducible conditions
- Cooperating threads
 - Shared state between multiple threads
- Goal: correctness by design

Race condition: example 1

- Initially $x = 0$ and $y = 0$

Thread A

$x = 1;$

Thread B

$y = 2;$

- What are the possible values of x below after all threads finish?
 - Must be 1. Thread B does not interfere

Race condition: example 2

- Initially $x = 0$ and $y = 0$

Thread A

$x = y + 1;$

Thread B

$y = 2;$

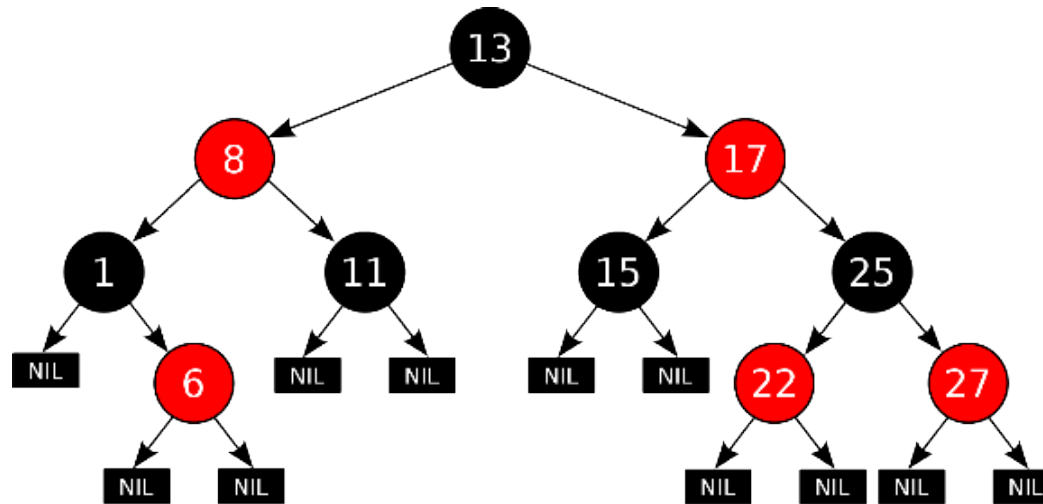
$y = y * 2;$

- What are the possible values of x below?
 - 1 or 3 or 5 (non-deterministically)
- Race condition: Thread A races against Thread B!

Example: shared data structure

Thread A
Insert(3)

Thread B
Insert(4)
Get(6)



Tree-Based Set Data Structure

- How do we make sure this executes correctly?

Relevant definitions

- **Synchronization**: Coordination among threads, usually regarding shared data
- **Mutual Exclusion**: Ensuring only one thread does a particular thing at a time (one thread excludes the others)
 - Type of synchronization
- **Critical Section**: Code exactly one thread can execute at once
 - Result of mutual exclusion
- **Lock**: An object only one thread can hold at a time
 - Provides mutual exclusion

Locks

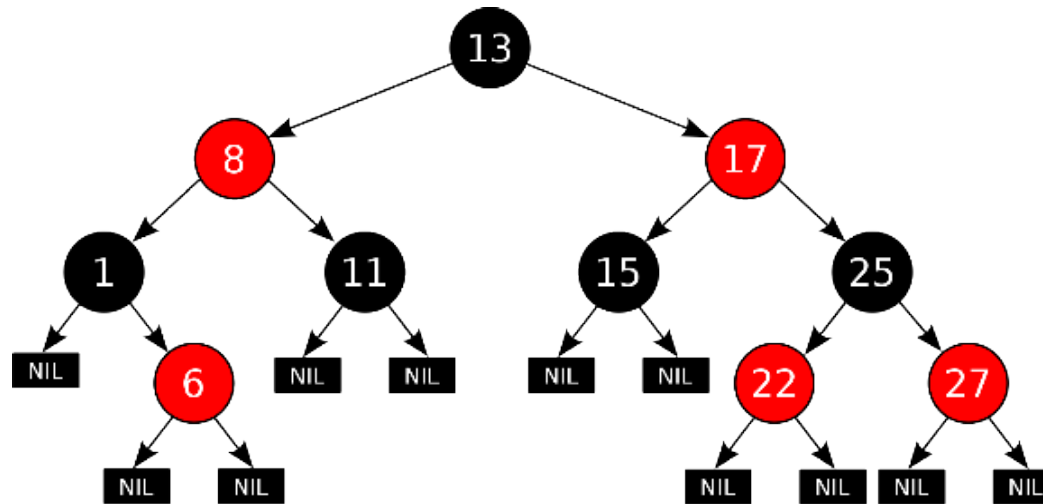
- Locks provide two atomic operations:
 - **Lock.acquire()** – wait until lock is free; then mark it as busy
 - After this returns, we say the calling thread holds the lock
 - **Lock.release()** – mark lock as free
 - Should only be called by a thread that currently holds the lock
 - After this returns, the calling thread no longer holds the lock
- For now, don't worry about how to implement locks!
 - We'll cover that in substantial depth later on in the class

Example: shared data structure

Thread A

Insert(3)

- lock.acquire()
- Insert 3 into the data structure
- lock.release()



Tree-Based Set Data Structure

Thread B

Insert(4)

- lock.acquire()
 - Insert 4 into the data structure
 - lock.release()
- Get(6)
- lock.acquire()
 - Check for membership
 - lock.release()

OS library hooks: *pthread*s

```
int pthread_mutex_init(pthread_mutex_t *mutex,  
                        const pthread_mutexattr_t *attr)
```

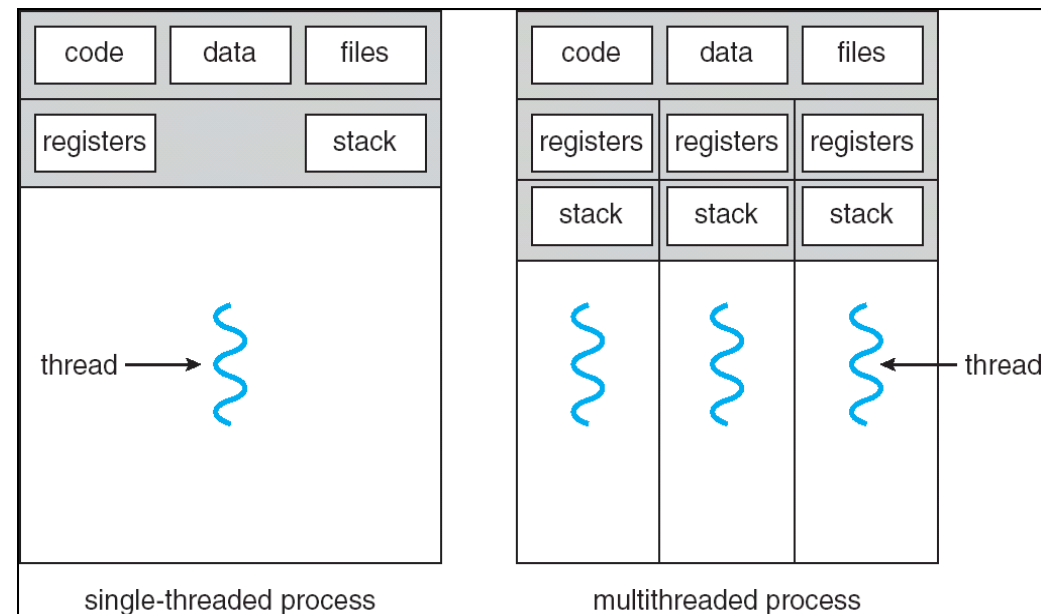
```
int pthread_mutex_lock(pthread_mutex_t *mutex);  
int pthread_mutex_unlock(pthread_mutex_t *mutex);
```

- You'll get a chance to use these in Assignment 1

Processes

Managing processes

- How to manage process state?
 - How to create a process?
 - How to exit from a process?
- Remember: everything outside of the kernel is running in a process!
- Processes are created and managed by...
processes!



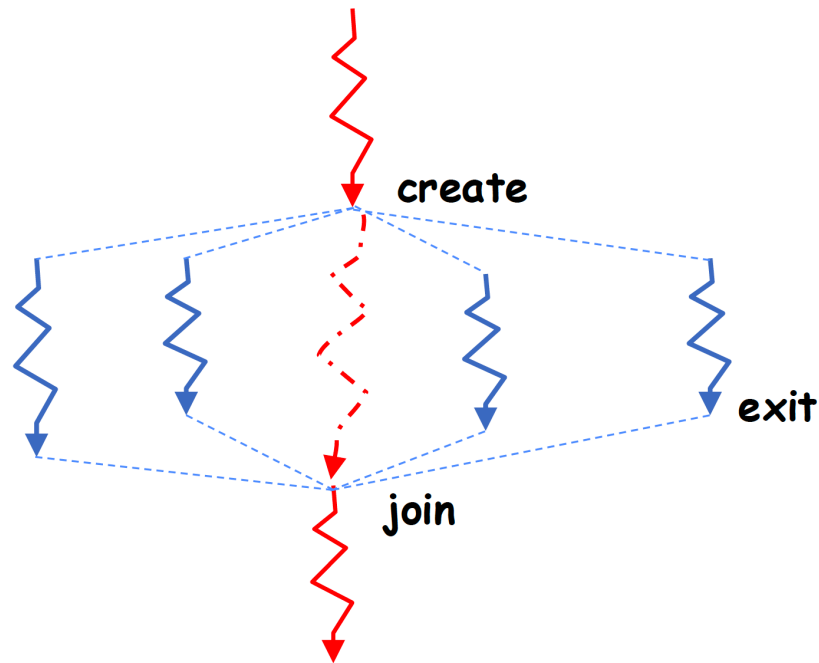
Process management API

- `exit` – terminate a process
- `fork` – copy the current process
- `exec` – change the program being run by the current process
- `wait` – wait for a process to finish
- `kill` – send a signal (interrupt-like notification) to another process
- `sigaction` – set handlers for signals

Recall threads

```
void pthread_exit  
int pthread_create  
pthread_join
```

Recall: fork-join pattern



- Main thread *creates* (forks) collection of sub-threads passing them args to work on...
- ... and then *joins* with them, collecting results.

Process management API

- `exit` – terminate a process
- `fork` – copy the current process
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pid.c

```
#include <stdlib.h>
#include <stdio.h>
#include <unistd.h>

int main(int argc, char *argv[]) {
    /* get current process' PID */
    pid_t pid = getpid();
    printf("My pid: %d\n", pid);

    exit(0);
}
```

- Q: What if we let main return without ever calling exit?
 - The OS Library calls exit() for us!
 - The entrypoint of the executable is in the OS library
 - OS library calls main
 - If main returns, OS library calls exit

Process management API

- `exit` – terminate a process
- `fork` – copy the current process
- `exec` – change the program being run by the current process
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Creating processes

- `pid_t fork()` – copy the current process
 - New process has different pid
 - New process contains a single thread
- Return value from `fork()`: pid (like an integer)
 - When > 0 :
 - Running in (original) **parent** process
 - return value is **pid** of new child
 - When $= 0$:
 - Running in new **child** process
 - When < 0 :
 - Error! Must handle somehow
 - Running in original process
- **State of original process duplicated in *both* parent and child!**
 - **Address Space (Memory), File Descriptors (covered later), etc...**

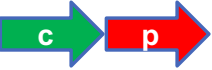
fork1.c

```
#include <stdlib.h>  #include <stdio.h>
#include <unistd.h>  #include <sys/types.h>

int main(int argc, char *argv[]) {
    pid_t cpid, mypid;
    pid_t pid = getpid();           /* get current process' PID */
    printf("Parent pid: %d\n", pid);
    cpid = fork();
    if (cpid > 0) {                  /* parent process */
        mypid = getpid();
        printf("[%d] parent of [%d]\n", mypid, cpid);
    } else if (cpid == 0) {          /* child process */
        mypid = getpid();
        printf("[%d] child\n", mypid);
    } else {
        perror("Fork failed");
    }
}
```

fork1.c

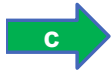
```
#include <stdlib.h>  #include <stdio.h>
#include <unistd.h>  #include <sys/types.h>

int main(int argc, char *argv[]) {
    pid_t cpid, mypid;
    pid_t pid = getpid();           /* get current process' PID */
    printf("Parent pid: %d\n", pid);
     cpid = fork();
    if (cpid > 0) {                 /* parent process */
        mypid = getpid();
        printf("[%d] parent of [%d]\n", mypid, cpid);
    } else if (cpid == 0) {         /* child process */
        mypid = getpid();
        printf("[%d] child\n", mypid);
    } else {
        perror("Fork failed");
    }
}
```

fork1.c

```
#include <stdlib.h>  #include <stdio.h>
#include <unistd.h>  #include <sys/types.h>

int main(int argc, char *argv[]) {
    pid_t cpid, mypid;
    pid_t pid = getpid();           /* get current process' PID */
    printf("Parent pid: %d\n", pid);
    cpid = fork();
    if (cpid > 0) {                  /* parent process */
        mypid = getpid();
        printf("[%d] parent of [%d]\n", mypid, cpid);
    } else if (cpid == 0) {          /* child process */
        mypid = getpid();
        printf("[%d] child\n", mypid);
    } else {
        perror("Fork failed");
    }
}
```



Mystery: fork_race.c

```
int i;
pid_t cpid = fork();
if (cpid > 0) {
    for (i = 0; i < 10; i++) {
        printf("Parent: %d\n", i);
        // sleep(1);
    }
} else if (cpid == 0) {
    for (i = 0; i > -10; i--) {
        printf("Child: %d\n", i);
        // sleep(1);
    }
}
```

- Recall: a process consists of one or more threads executing in an address space
- Here, each process has a single thread
- These threads execute concurrently
- What does this print?
- Would adding the calls to sleep() matter?

Process management API

- `exit` – terminate a process
- `fork` – copy the current process
- `exec` – change the program being run by the current process
- `wait` – wait for a process to finish
- `kill` – send a signal (interrupt-like notification) to another process
- `sigaction` – set handlers for signals

Starting a new program: variants of exec

```
...
cpid = fork();
if (cpid > 0) {                                /* parent process */
    tcpid = wait(&status)
    printf("[%d] parent of [%d]\n", mypid, cpid);
} else if (cpid == 0) {                        /* child process */
    char *args[] = {"ls", "-l", NULL};
    execv("/bin/ls", args);

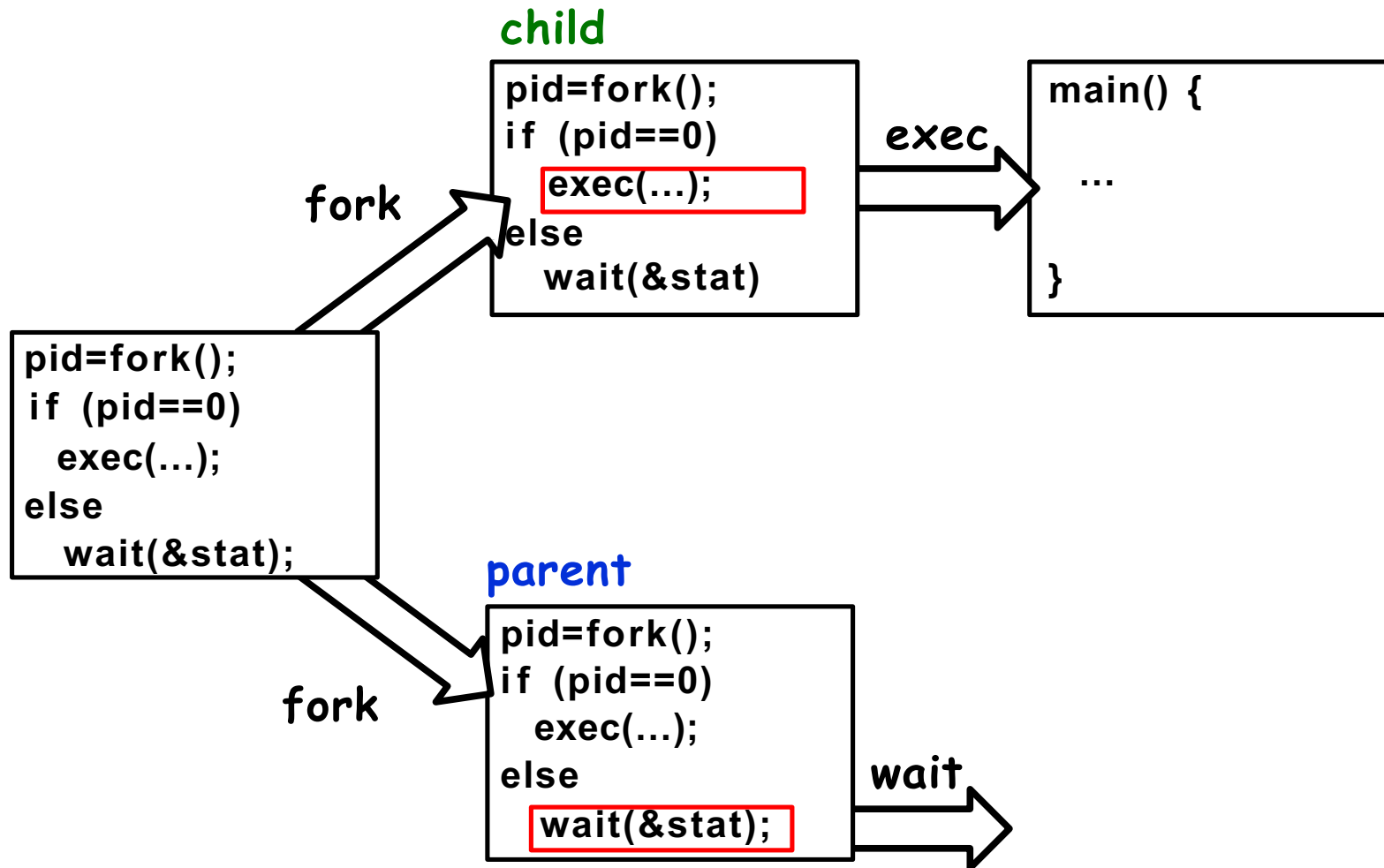
    /* execv doesn't return when it works.
       So, if we got here, it failed! */

    perror("execv");
    exit(1);
}
...
```

fork2.c – parent waits for child to finish

```
int status;
pid_t tcpid;
...
cpid = fork();
if (cpid > 0) {                               /* parent process */
    mypid = getpid();
    printf("[%d] parent of [%d]\n", mypid, cpid);
    tcpid = wait(&status);
    printf("[%d] bye %d(%d)\n", mypid, tcpid, status);
} else if (cpid == 0) { /* Child Process */
    mypid = getpid();
    printf("[%d] child\n", mypid);
    char *args[] = {"ls", "-l", NULL};
    execv("/bin/ls", args);
    ...
}
...
```

Process management: the Shell pattern



Process management API

- `exit` – terminate a process
- `fork` – copy the current process
- `exec` – change the program being run by the current process
- `wait` – wait for a process to finish
- `kill` – send a signal (interrupt-like notification) to another process
- `sigaction` – set handlers for signals

inf_loop.c

```
#include <stdlib.h>
#include <stdio.h>
#include <signal.h>

void signal_callback_handler(int signum) {
    printf("Caught signal!\n");
    exit(1);
}

int main() {
    struct sigaction sa;
    sa.sa_flags = 0;
    sigemptyset(&sa.sa_mask);
    sa.sa_handler = signal_callback_handler;
    sigaction(SIGINT, &sa, NULL);
    while (1) {}
}
```

A red arrow points from the `signal_callback_handler` function name in the assignment `sa.sa_handler = signal_callback_handler;` to the function definition `void signal_callback_handler(int signum) {`.

- Q: What would happen if the process receives a SIGINT signal, but does not register a signal handler?
 - The process dies!
- For each signal, there is a default handler defined by the system

Process management API

- SIGINT – control-C
- SIGTERM – default for shell command `kill`
- SIGSTOP – control-Z (default action: stop process)
- SIGKILL, SIGSTOP – wait for a process to finish
 - Can't be changed with `sigaction`
 - Why?

Process vs. thread API

- Why have `fork()` and `exec()` system calls for processes, but just a `pthread_create()` function for threads?
 - Convenient to fork without `exec`: put code for parent and child in one executable instead of multiple
 - It will allow us to programmatically control child process' state
 - By executing code before calling `exec()` in the child
 - We'll see this in the case of File I/O later
- Windows uses `CreateProcess()` instead of `fork()`
 - Also works, but a more complicated interface

Group discussion

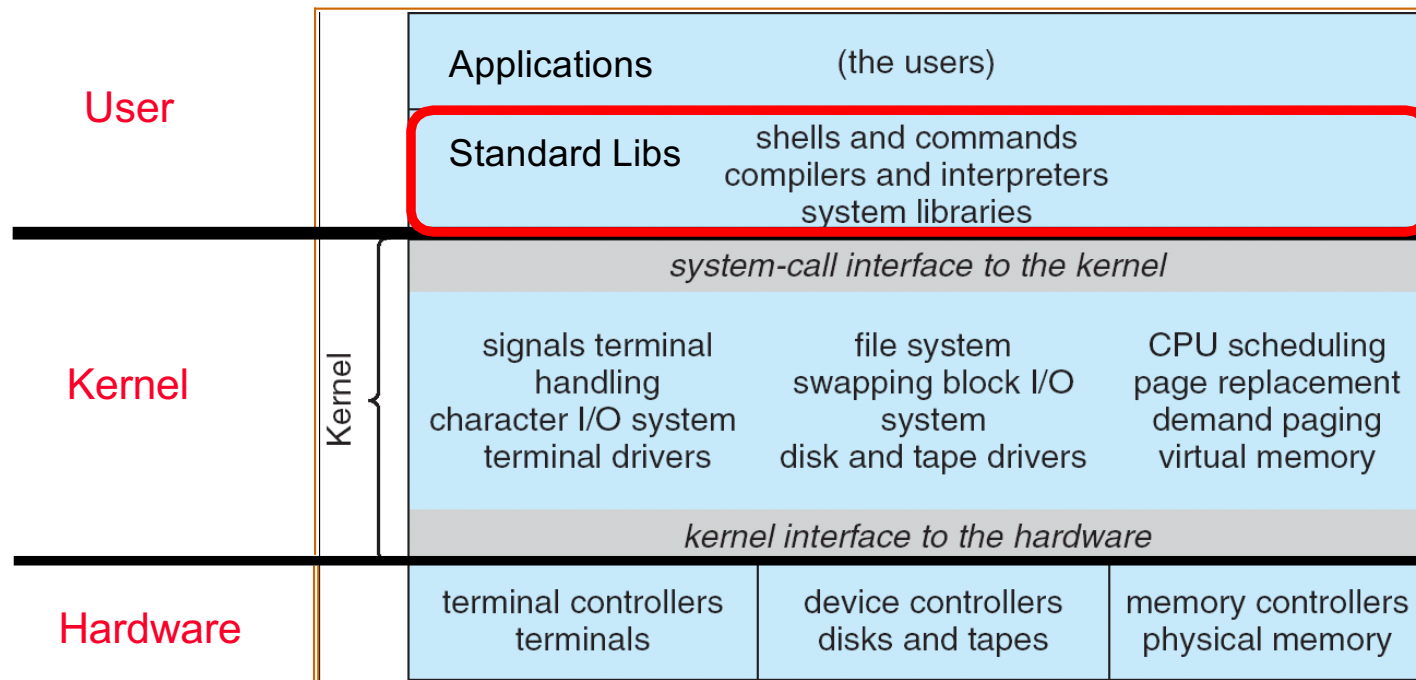
- Topic: processes vs. threads
 - If we have two tasks to run concurrently, do we run them in separate threads, or do we run them in separate processes?
 - What are the pros and cons?
- Discuss in groups of two to three students
 - Each group chooses a leader to summarize the discussion
 - In your group discussion, please do not dominate the discussion, and give everyone a chance to speak

(Optional) runtime-managed concurrency: illusion of threads

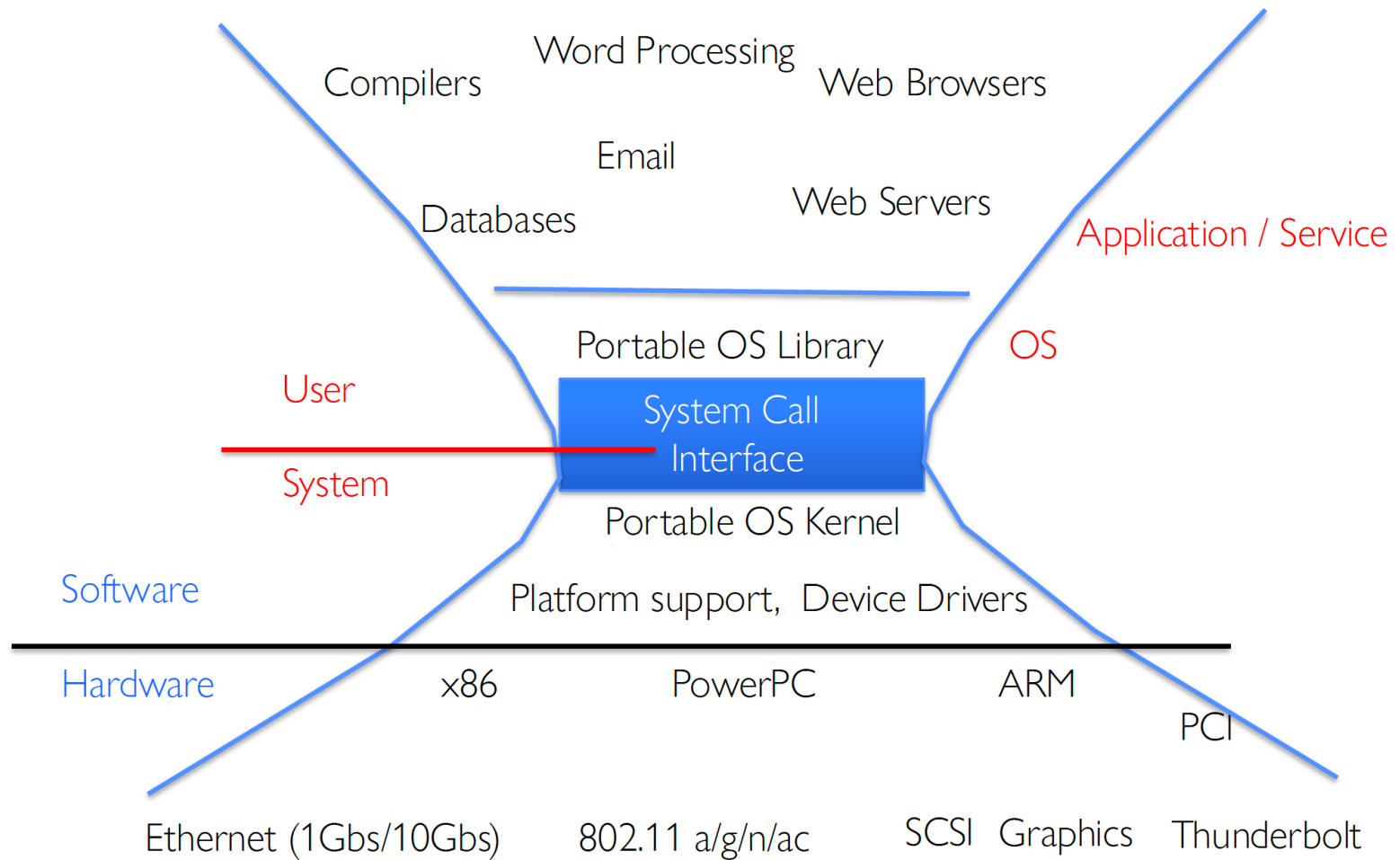
- Are processes and threads enough? Do we need a different design with different trade-offs?
- Languages like Golang introduces goroutines
- This adds a runtime layer between your code and OS threads
- This layer controls scheduling and switching, instead of the OS!
- Trade-off: simplicity and scale in exchange for direct OS control
- Read more here: <https://omjogani.github.io/blogs/posts/the-ultimate-guide-to-concurrency-with-go-routines/>

Files

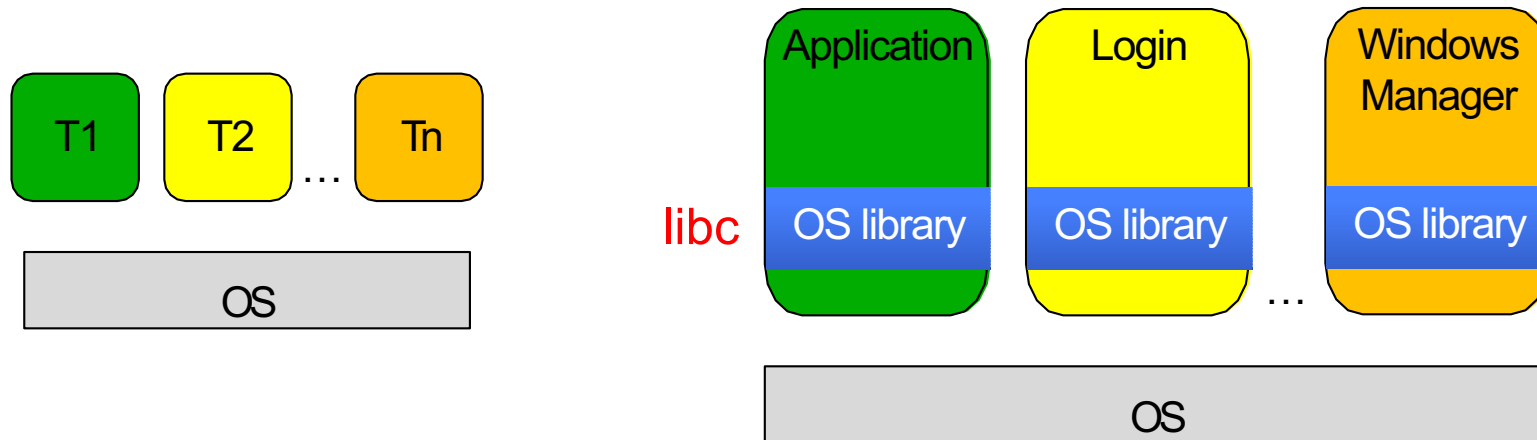
Recall: UNIX system structure



A kind of narrow waist



Recall: OS library (libc) issues syscalls



- OS Library: Code linked into the user-level application that provides a clean or more functional API to the user than just the raw syscalls
 - Most of this code runs at user level, but makes syscalls (which run at kernel level)

UNIX/POSIX idea: everything is a “file”

- Almost identical interface for:
 - Files on disk
 - Devices (terminals, printers, etc.)
 - Regular files on disk
 - Networking (sockets)
 - Local interprocess communication (pipes, sockets)
- Based on the system calls `open()`, `read()`, `write()`, & `close()`
- Additional: `ioctl()` for custom configuration that doesn't quite fit
- Note that the “Everything is a File” idea was a radical idea when proposed
 - Dennis Ritchie and Ken Thompson described this idea in their seminal paper on UNIX called “The UNIX Time-Sharing System” from 1974
 - Available [online](#)

Aside: POSIX interfaces

- **POSIX**: **P**ortable **O**perating **S**ystem **I**nterface (for uni**X**?)
 - Interface for application programmers (mostly)
 - Defines the term “Unix,” derived from AT&T Unix
 - Created to bring order to many Unix-derived OSes, so applications are portable
 - Partially available on non-Unix OSes, like Windows
 - Requires standard system call interface

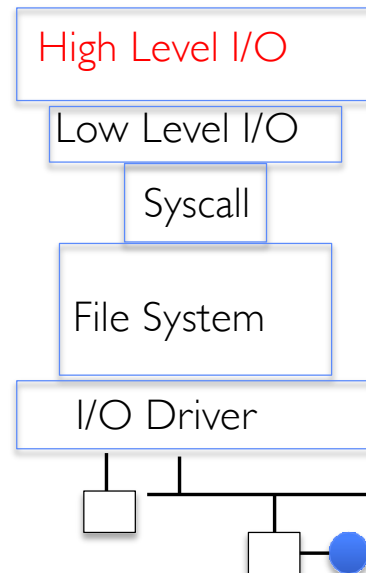
The file system abstraction

- File
 - Named collection of data in a file system
 - POSIX File data: sequence of bytes
 - Could be text, binary, serialized objects, ...
 - File Metadata: information about the file
 - Size, Modification Time, Owner, Security info, Access control
- Directory
 - “Folder” containing files & directories
 - Hierarchical naming
 - Path through the directory graph
 - Uniquely identifies a file or directory
 - Links and Volumes (later)

Connecting processes, file systems, and users

- Every process has a *current working directory (CWD)*
 - Can be set with system call:
`int chdir(const char *path); //change CWD`
- Absolute paths ignore CWD
 - `/home/oski/csc3150`
- Relative paths are relative to CWD
 - `index.html`, `./index.html`
 - Refers to `index.html` in current working directory
 - `../index.html`
 - Refers to `index.html` in parent of current working directory
 - `~/index.html`, `~csc3150/index.html`
 - Refers to `index.html` in the home directory

I/O and storage layers



Streams (buffered I/O)

File Descriptors

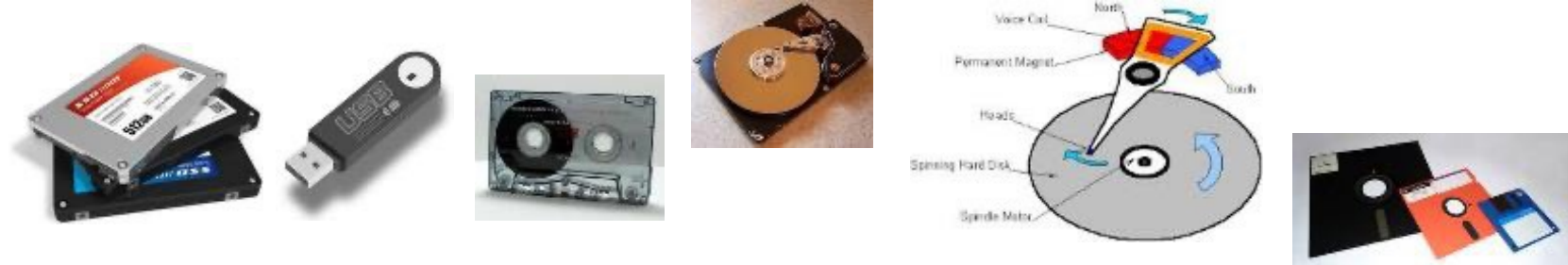
open(), read(), write(), close(), ...

Open File Descriptions

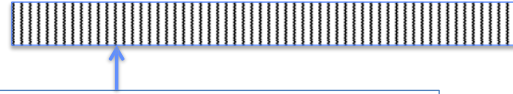
Files/Directories/Indexes

Commands and Data Transfers

Disks, Flash, Controllers, DMA



C high-level file API – streams

- Operates on “streams” – unformatted sequences of bytes (with text or binary data), with a position: 

```
#include <stdio.h>
FILE *fopen( const char *filename, const char *mode );
int fclose( FILE *fp );
```

Mode	Text	Binary	Descriptions
r		rb	Open existing file for reading
w		wb	Open for writing; created if does not exist
a		ab	Open for appending; created if does not exist
r+		rb+	Open existing file for reading & writing.
w+		wb+	Open for reading & writing; truncated to zero if exists, create otherwise
a+		ab+	Open for reading & writing. Created if does not exist. Read from beginning, write as append

- Open stream represented by **pointer** to a **FILE** data structure
 - Error reported by returning a NULL pointer

C API standard stream – `stdio.h`

- Three predefined streams are opened implicitly when the program is executed.
 - FILE `*stdin` – normal source of input, can be redirected
 - FILE `*stdout` – normal source of output, can too
 - FILE `*stderr` – diagnostics and errors
- `STDIN` / `STDOUT` enable composition in Unix
- All can be redirected
 - `cat hello.txt | grep "World!"`
 - **cat's `stdout` goes to `grep's stdin`**

C high-level file API

```
// character oriented
int fputc( int c, FILE *fp );           // return c or EOF on err
int fputs( const char *s, FILE *fp );   // return > 0 or EOF

int fgetc( FILE * fp );
char *fgets( char *buf, int n, FILE *fp );

// block oriented
size_t fread(void *ptr, size_t size_of_elements,
              size_t number_of_elements, FILE *a_file);
size_t fwrite(const void *ptr, size_t size_of_elements,
              size_t number_of_elements, FILE *a_file);

// formatted
int fprintf(FILE *restrict stream, const char *restrict format, ...);
int fscanf(FILE *restrict stream, const char *restrict format, ... );
```

C streams: char-by-char I/O

```
int main(void) {  
    FILE* input = fopen("input.txt", "r");  
    FILE* output = fopen("output.txt", "w");  
    int c;  
  
    c = fgetc(input);  
    while (c != EOF) {  
        fputc(output, c);  
        c = fgetc(input);  
    }  
    fclose(input);  
    fclose(output);  
}
```

C high-level file API

```
// character oriented
int fputc( int c, FILE *fp );           // return c or EOF on err
int fputs( const char *s, FILE *fp );   // return > 0 or EOF

int fgetc( FILE * fp );
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// block oriented
size_t fread(void *ptr, size_t size_of_elements,
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// formatted
int fprintf(FILE *restrict stream, const char *restrict format, ...);
int fscanf(FILE *restrict stream, const char *restrict format, ... );
```

C streams: block-by-block I/O

```
#define BUFFER_SIZE 1024
int main(void) {
    FILE* input = fopen("input.txt", "r");
    FILE* output = fopen("output.txt", "w");
    char buffer[BUFFER_SIZE];
    size_t length;
    length = fread(buffer, sizeof(char), BUFFER_SIZE, input);
    while (length > 0) {
        fwrite(buffer, sizeof(char), length, output);
        length = fread(buffer, sizeof(char), BUFFER_SIZE, input);
    }
    fclose(input);
    fclose(output);
}
```

Aside: check your errors!

- Systems programmers should always be paranoid!
 - Otherwise, you get intermittently buggy code

- We should really be writing things like:

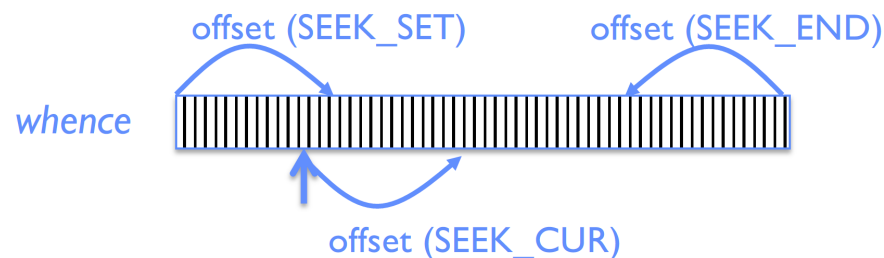
```
FILE* input = fopen("input.txt", "r");  
if (input == NULL) {  
    // Prints our string and error msg  
    perror("Failed to open input file");  
}
```

- **Be thorough about checking return values!**
 - Want failures to be systematically caught and dealt with
- I may be a bit loose with error checking for examples in class (to keep short)
 - **Do as I say, not as I show in class!**

C high-level file API: positioning the pointer

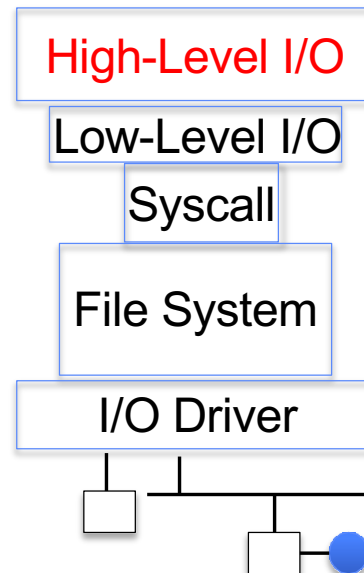
```
int fseek(FILE *stream, long int offset, int whence)  
long int ftell(FILE *stream)  
void rewind(FILE *stream)
```

- For `fseek()`, the offset is interpreted based on the whence argument (constants in `stdio.h`):
 - `SEEK_SET`: Then offset interpreted from beginning (position 0)
 - `SEEK_END`: Then offset interpreted backwards from end of file
 - `SEEK_CUR`: Then offset interpreted from current position



- Overall preserves high-level abstraction of a uniform stream of objects

I/O and storage layers



Streams (buffered I/O)

File Descriptors

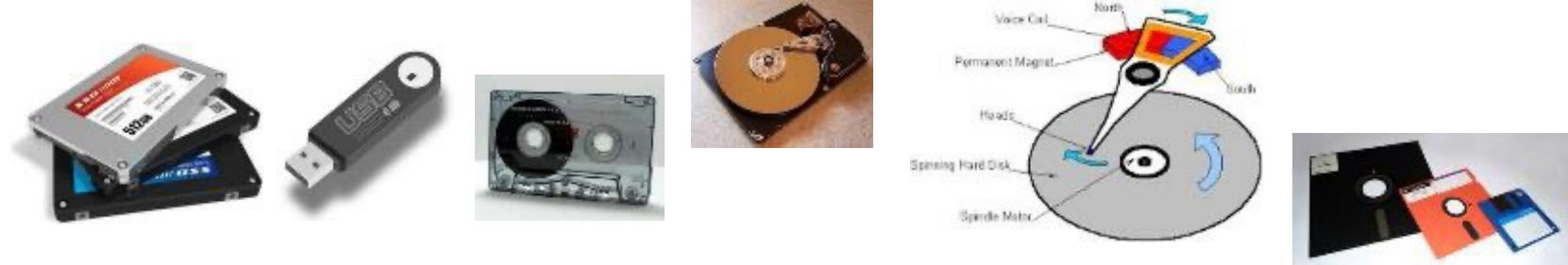
open(), read(), write(), close(), ...

Open File Descriptions

Files/Directories/Indexes

Commands and Data Transfers

Disks, Flash, Controllers, DMA



Low-level file I/O: the RAW system-call interface

```
#include <fcntl.h>  #include <unistd.h>  #include <sys/types.h>
int open (const char *filename, int flags [, mode_t mode])
int creat (const char *filename, mode_t mode)
int close (int filedes)
```

Bit vector of:

- Access modes (Rd,Wr, ...)
- Open Flags (Create, ...)
- Operating modes (Appends, ...)

Bit vector of Permission Bits:

- User|Group|Other X R|W|X

- Integer return from open() is a *file descriptor*
 - Error indicated by return < 0: the global errno variable set with error (see man pages)
- Operations on file descriptors:
 - Open system call create an open file description entry in system-wide table of open files
 - Open file description object in the kernel represents an instance of an open file
 - Why give user an integer instead of a pointer to the file description in kernel?

C low-level (pre-opened) standard descriptors

```
#include <unistd.h>
```

```
STDIN_FILENO  – macro has value 0
```

```
STDOUT_FILENO – macro has value 1
```

```
STDERR_FILENO – macro has value 2
```

```
// Get file descriptor inside FILE *
```

```
int fileno (FILE *stream)
```

```
// Make FILE * from descriptor
```

```
FILE * fdopen (int fildes, const char *opentype)
```

Low-level file API

- Read data from open file using file descriptor:
`ssize_t read (int filedes, void *buffer, size_t maxsize)`
 - Reads up to maxsize bytes – **might actually read less!**
 - returns bytes read, 0 => EOF, -1 => error
- Write data to open file using file descriptor
`ssize_t write (int filedes, const void *buffer, size_t size)`
 - returns number of bytes written
- Reposition file offset within kernel (this is independent of any position held by high-level FILE descriptor for this file!)
`off_t lseek (int filedes, off_t offset, int whence)`

Example: lowio.c

```
int main() {  
    char buf[1000];  
    int    fd = open("lowio.c", O_RDONLY);  
    ssize_t rd = read(fd, buf, sizeof(buf));  
    int    err = close(fd);  
    ssize_t wr = write(STDOUT_FILENO, buf, rd);  
}
```

- How many bytes does this program read?

POSIX I/O: design patterns

- Open before use
 - Access control check, setup happens here
- Byte-oriented
 - Least common denominator
 - OS responsible for hiding the fact that real devices may not work this way (e.g. hard drive stores data in blocks)
- Explicit close

POSIX I/O: kernel buffering

- Reads are buffered inside kernel
 - Part of making everything byte-oriented
 - Process is blocked while waiting for device
 - Let other processes run while gathering result
- Writes are buffered inside kernel
 - Complete in background (more later on)
 - Return to user when data is “handed off” to kernel
- This buffering is part of global buffer management and caching for block devices (such as disks)
 - Items typically cached in quanta of disk block sizes
 - We will have many interesting things to say about this buffering when we dive into the kernel

Low-level I/O: other operations

- Operations specific to terminals, devices, networking, ...
 - e.g., `ioctl`
- Duplicating descriptors
 - `int dup2(int old, int new);`
 - `int dup(int old);`
- Pipes – channel
 - `int pipe(pipefd[2]);`
 - Writes to `pipefd[1]` can be read from `pipefd[0]`
- File Locking
- Memory-Mapping Files
- Asynchronous I/O

Low-level vs. high-level file API

- Low-level direct use of syscall interface:
`open(), read(), write(), close()`
- Opening of file returns file descriptor:
`int myfile = open(...);`
- File descriptor only meaningful to kernel
 - Index into process (PDB) which holds pointers to kernel-level structure ("file description") describing file.
- Every `read()` or `write()` causes syscall no matter how small (could read a single byte)
- Consider loop to get 4 bytes at a time using `read()`:
 - Each iteration enters kernel for 4 bytes.

- High-level buffered access:
`fopen(), fread(), fwrite(), fclose()`
- Opening of file returns ptr to FILE:
`FILE *myfile = fopen(...);`
- FILE structure in user space contains:
 - a chunk of memory for a buffer
 - the file descriptor for the file (`fopen()` will call `open()` automatically)
- Every `fread()` or `fwrite()` filters through buffer and may not call `read()` or `write()` on every call.
- Consider loop to get 4 bytes at a time using `fread()`:
 - First call to `fread()` calls `read()` for block of bytes (say 1024). Puts in buffer and returns first 4 to user.
 - Subsequent `fread()` grab bytes from buffer

Low-level vs. high-level file API

- Low-level operations

```
ssize_t read(...) {
```

asm code ... syscall # into %eax
put args into registers %ebx, ...
special trap instruction

Kernel:

get args from regs
dispatch to system func
do the work to read from the file
store return value in %eax

get return values from reg

return data to caller

```
}
```

- High-level operations

```
ssize_t fread(...) {
```

check buffer for contents

return data to caller if available

asm code ... syscall # into %eax
put args into registers %ebx, ...
special trap instruction

Kernel:

get args from regs
dispatch to system func
do the work to read from the file
store return value in %eax

get return values from reg

update buffer with excess data

return data to caller }

Low-level vs. high-level file API

- Low-level operations on file descriptors are visible immediately

```
write(STDOUT_FILENO, "Beginning of line ", 18);
sleep(10);
write("and end of line \n", 16);
```

 - Outputs "Beginning of line" 10 seconds earlier than "and end of line"
- High-level streams are buffered in user memory:

```
printf("Beginning of line ");
sleep(10); // sleep for 10 seconds
printf("and end of line\n");
```

 - Prints out everything at once

Group discussion

- Topic: buffer in user space
 - Why buffer in user space? Why not?
 - What are the pros and cons?
- Discuss in groups of two to three students
 - Each group chooses a leader to summarize the discussion
 - In your group discussion, please do not dominate the discussion, and give everyone a chance to speak

Why buffer in userspace? Overhead!

- Syscalls are more expensive than function calls
- read/write a file byte by byte? Max throughput of ~10MB/second
- With fgetc? Keeps up with your SSD

Why buffer in userspace? Functionality!

- System call operations less capable
 - Simplifies kernel
- Example: No “read until new line” operation in kernel
 - Why? Kernel agnostic about formatting!
 - Solution: Make a big read syscall, find first new line in userspace
 - i.e. use one of the following high-level options:
`char *fgets(char *s, int size, FILE *stream);`
`ssize_t getline(char **lineptr, size_t *n, FILE *stream);`

Conclusion

- System call interface is “narrow waist” between user programs and kernel
 - Must enter kernel atomically by setting PC to kernel routine at same time that CPU enters kernel mode
- Processes consist of one or more threads in an address space
 - Abstraction of the machine: execution environment for a program
 - Can use fork, exec, etc. to manage threads within a process
- We saw the role of the OS library
 - Provide API to programs
 - Interface with the OS to request services
- Streaming IO: modeled as a stream of bytes
 - Most streaming I/O functions start with “f” (like “fread”)
 - Data buffered automatically by C-library function
- Low-level I/O:
 - File descriptors are integers
 - Low-level I/O supported directly at system call level

Thanks